

Use Case

Automatically append the monthly CSV data sent to your Gmail into your main Postgres database—no manual imports needed.

Mindset / Thought Process

1. I'll assume users just email the monthly sales data in email (in CSV Format)
 2. I'll assume the CSV headers match the table column names exactly.
 3. I'll treat n8n as the low-code bridge linking email, data parsing, and database.
 4. I'll validate at every step that we have a CSV and that its structure fits our schema before moving on.
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Solution Design

- Watch your Gmail inbox for incoming messages.
 - Fetch the message content along with any attachments.
 - Filter out everything except files ending in “.csv.”
 - Parse each CSV into structured rows based on the header.
 - Append those rows directly into your Postgres table.
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Step-by-Step Execution

Step 1: Set up n8n

Get a trial account (14 days) here - <https://app.n8n.cloud/register>

(or)

Set up a local hosting setup, follow the guide attached in the lecture - <LINK>

Step 2: Get Help from ChatGPT / Perplexity to Draft the Flow

Use an AI tool like ChatGPT or Perplexity to help you outline the rough steps. - [LINK](#)

Prompt:

I want to create an automation in n8n where, when someone sends me a CSV file by email, it should automatically read the file and insert its rows into a Postgres table. Help me list down the exact steps I should follow.

Step 3: Monitor Incoming Mail

Configure an email-watcher node on your Gmail account and enable attachment capture.

Step 4: Retrieve Content and Attachments

Use a node that pulls in each new email's subject, body, and attached files using something that gets everything for that mail.

Step 5: Turn CSVs into Rows

Add a CSV-parse node to convert the binary file into JSON rows, using the first row as headers.

Step 6: Load Data into Postgres

Connect a row-insert node to your Postgres instance, mapping each CSV column to its matching table column.

Step 7: Test, Tweak, and Go Live

Email yourself a sample CSV, execute the workflow, confirm the new rows in Postgres, then switch the workflow on and monitor the first few runs.

Final Outcome

- Monthly CSVs emailed to you are automatically added to your Postgres table.
- Manual imports and human errors vanish.
- The workflow stays modular, reliable, and easy to maintain.